

BPP APPRENTICES MAY 2026 EDITION NEWSLETTER



Building Careers
Through Education



HELLO APPRENTICES!

Welcome to this May edition of the BPP Apprentice newsletter!

SUSTAINABILITY FOCUS

Healthy, Sustainable Eating

Sustainability and healthy eating are closely linked. The food choices we make affect not just our health, but the environment too. Simple changes – like eating more plant-based meals, cutting down on food waste, and choosing seasonal foods – can make a real difference without feeling restrictive. Small, practical habits can support your wellbeing while helping reduce environmental impact. For more on how diet and sustainability connect, explore WWF's guide to sustainable eating: <https://www.wwf.org.uk/food>

DISCOVER, LEARN, LEVEL UP: SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY MASTERCLASSES

Looking to explore the latest and greatest in tech while building skills that will supercharge your career? Our School of Technology Masterclasses are here to do just that.

These hour-long, bite-sized sessions are designed to give you a flavour of the most cutting-edge topics in technology alongside essential professional skills. From AI and emerging tech, to leadership, productivity, career development, there's something to inspire everyone.

Each Masterclass is led by industry experts, including engaging inhouse specialists and speakers from external organisations. They're carefully crafted to be practical, interactive, and hands-on, so you'll walk away with insights and skills you can apply straight away in the workplace.

The last Friday of every month, the School of Technology hosts Masterclasses that are open to all Apprentices.

They're a brilliant opportunity to:

- Explore topics beyond your standard apprenticeship
- Broaden your technical knowledge
- Gain fresh perspectives from industry professionals
- Take the next step in shaping your future career



Masterclass

Lunch and Learn

Human + Machine:
Collaborating with AI at Work

Date
29 May, 2026
12:00 PM

Book Here!



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Don't miss out these sessions are your chance to learn more, try something new, get ahead. Keep an eye out for upcoming Masterclasses and jump in



BPP CAREERS SERVICE



ABOUT THE BPP CAREERS SERVICE



The Careers Service is here to support you throughout your apprenticeship, helping you plan your next steps, strengthen your employability skills and feel confident about your future.

We offer clear, practical careers information, guidance and online support to help you develop as a BPP apprentice.

Our goal is to ensure you have the knowledge, skills and support you need to thrive during your apprenticeship and continue to succeed in the career that follows.



PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AWARD

Join our **Professional Development Award**. An exclusive award for current BPP apprentices where you can upgrade your skills by attending sessions and gain an award for your CV once completed.



SKILLS DEVELOPMENT SESSIONS



Lookout for **skills workshops and events** delivered by BPP Careers Service. Each apprentice school has a dedicated timetable of events, which is advertised to you usually via the hub.



ONLINE APPOINTMENTS



Free **impartial and confidential 1-2-1 advice** is available for all apprentices (plus 18 months post-completion). Simply email the address below to enquire about an appointment.



BPP FUTURES

Access **online resources** to support you with your apprenticeship and future progression:

<https://bppfutures.bppuniversity.ac.uk>

Use the **Skills Builder** to improve skills and earn badges you can post on LinkedIn.

For more information email: **employability@bpp.com**



TOPIC OF THE MONTH

Inclusion and Diversity

In today's workplace, success isn't just about qualifications or technical ability. Strong workplace skills, especially inclusion and diversity awareness, are essential for building positive working relationships and supporting career progression.

Diversity refers to the range of differences between people in a workplace. This can include differences in age, gender, ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation, religion, background, education, thinking styles, and life experiences.

Inclusion, meanwhile, is about how those differences are valued and respected. An inclusive workplace ensures that everyone feels welcomed, listened to, and able to contribute fully regardless of who they are.

Diversity is about being invited into the room; inclusion is about having a voice once you're there.

Inclusive and diverse workplaces are more productive, creative, and supportive. When people feel comfortable being themselves, they are more likely to:

- Share ideas and work well in teams
- Feel motivated and confident
- Communicate openly and respectfully.
- Perform at their best

For apprentices, learning how to work inclusively from the start helps build strong professional habits that last throughout a career.

Key inclusive behaviours include:

- **Respectful communication:** listening actively and valuing others' perspectives
- **Awareness:** recognising unconscious bias and being open to learning
- **Teamwork:** supporting colleagues and encouraging participation
- **Professional behaviour:** treating everyone fairly and with dignity

These skills are often part of apprenticeship standards because they are essential in any job role.

What You Can Do as an Apprentice

Every apprentice plays a part in creating an inclusive culture.

Simple actions make a big difference, such as:

- Using respectful and inclusive language
- Being open-minded when working with others
- Offering support and kindness to colleagues
- Speaking up or seeking advice if something doesn't feel right

Want to attend a skills session?
[Click here to see the timeables of events](#)

How do you demonstrate professionalism?

Professionalism isn't just something you learn at the start of your career, it's something you live every single day. It influences how you communicate, how you care, and how you carry yourself in every setting. The NMC describes professionalism in nursing as ensuring the consistent delivery of safe, effective, person-centred care that supports people, their families, and carers.

At the heart of this are the behaviours and expectations set out in The Code, which underpin your practice:

- Being accountable – practising effectively and taking responsibility for your actions
- Being a leader – promoting professionalism and trust in every interaction
- Being competent – preserving safety by maintaining knowledge, skills, and confidence
- Being an advocate – prioritising people and speaking up for what is right



But professionalism isn't demonstrated only in clinical situations. It also shows in how you approach your learning journey. Reflecting on your experiences, identifying what you've learned, and linking this to the Rule of Law helps you demonstrate not just what you do, but why you do it.

Your progress reviews are a powerful space to showcase this ongoing growth.



BPP Careers – Future Talent Development page is now live on all apprentices' BPP Hub homepages

Professional Etiquette
13 May 2026 @ 12.30 – 13.30

Professionalism is more than just first impressions; it's about consistently showing up with respect, confidence, and awareness. This session helps apprentices understand the often-unspoken rules of workplace etiquette, including:

- Effective communication styles
- Email tone and digital professionalism
- Appropriate dress and presentation
- Meeting behaviour and respectful collaboration

You'll learn how to navigate different workplace environments with confidence and polish, helping you present your best professional self every day.

[Join the meeting now](#)



Financial Exploitation: When Money Becomes a Safeguarding Issue

When we think about scams or financial harm, we often picture phishing emails or fake phone calls. But financial exploitation can also happen much closer to home – including within intimate relationships or friendships. Knowing the signs is an important part of protecting your wellbeing.

What is financial exploitation?

Financial exploitation happens when someone uses money, debt, or financial control to manipulate, pressure, or harm another person. This can include a partner, ex-partner, family member, or even a close friend. It's a form of abuse and is recognised as a safeguarding concern because of its impact on independence, mental health, and long-term security.

Why this matters for apprentices

Financial exploitation can leave people feeling trapped, ashamed, or unable to leave unhealthy situations. It often sits alongside emotional manipulation and can have lasting effects on confidence, credit scores, housing, and career progression. Apprentices may be particularly vulnerable due to shared living costs, early career earnings, or feeling pressure to “help out” someone they care about



It can happen to anyone, especially during times of stress or financial difficulty.

Common warning signs You might notice:

- A partner pressuring you to share passwords, bank access, or take out loans in your name
- Being made to feel guilty for spending money on yourself
- Someone controlling how your wages are spent
- Being asked to cover debts that aren't yours
- Feeling anxious or secretive about money conversations
- Sudden financial stress that doesn't make sense

Trust your instincts – if something feels off, it's worth paying attention to.

How to protect yourself / support

Simple steps can make a big difference:

- Keep your financial details, passwords and PINs private – even in relationships
- Be cautious about joint accounts, contracts, or loans
- Talk to someone you trust if you feel pressured or uncomfortable
- Remember: saying “no” to money requests is reasonable and healthy
- If you're worried about your safety or wellbeing, seek support from safeguarding teams, HR, union reps or external services

Financial independence is part of wellbeing and inclusion. Support is available, and you're never “too old” or “too capable” to be affected by this – help-seeking is a strength, not a failure.

If You Need Support

If you are worried about financial exploitation, support is available:

- [Action Fraud](#) – Report fraud and cybercrime
- [Citizens Advice](#) – Free, confidential advice on money and legal issues
- [National Crime Agency](#) – Information on money mule risks and financial crime
- Your bank or financial provider – They can help secure your account
- [BPP Safeguarding and Wellbeing team](#) – Confidential advice and support

Understanding Islamist Extremism

What do we mean by Islamist extremism?

Islamist extremism is not the same as Islam.

Islam is a peaceful, diverse faith followed by millions of people around the world. Islamist extremism refers to a distorted political ideology that misuses religion to justify harm, control, or violence.

Extremist groups may:

- Claim they represent “true” beliefs while rejecting mainstream voices
- Promote intolerance, division, or violence
- Use propaganda to influence or recruit others

It is important to understand that extremism exists in many forms, and no single community should ever be blamed or stereotyped.

Why this matters for apprentices

As an apprentice, you are part of a wider community both online and offline. Understanding how extremism works helps you to:

- Stay safe from harmful influence
- Support others who may be vulnerable
- Challenge misinformation in a calm and informed way

The UK’s current national threat level is **SEVERE** – An attack is considered highly likely.

To find out about your local risk, check out the police website here and type in your postcode: police.uk/pu/yourarea/

Prevent is not about suspicion. It is about early support and safeguarding.

If you are concerned about someone within BPP then please contact:

prevent@bpp.com. For more information on the Prevent Duty, please visit [ACT Early](#) for advice and information.

Where to learn more or get support

If you want to better understand extremism or need guidance, these trusted resources can help:

- [Counter Extremism Project](#) – Research and insights into extremist ideologies
- [UK Home Office Extremism Guide](#) – Practical advice on recognising and responding to concerns
- [Your BPP Safeguarding and Wellbeing team](#) – Confidential advice and support
- Speak to your coach if something is worrying you

Our commitment to inclusion – We are committed to creating a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment for everyone. This means challenging discrimination, valuing different perspectives, and ensuring all learners feel supported regardless of their background, beliefs, or identity.

PREVENT Activity: Reflect and Discuss

Take 10–15 minutes to read the following link: [The Stages – ACT Early](#) and reflect on the following:

1. What is the difference between religion and extremist ideology?
2. Why is it important not to stereotype when discussing extremism?
3. What would you do if you were concerned about something you saw online?

Bring your reflections to your next check-in and discuss how you would respond to concerns in a safe and responsible way.